Hire / Call / Clone
Verification Checklist

Defending against deepfakes and fraudulent remote IT workers

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You can't count on spotting a fake. You can count on verifying the request through a channel the attacker doesn't control.

1 The Hire

HR, recruiting, IT onboarding, payroll

- [ ] **Camera stays on** for the whole interview. Video that drops for "network issues" is a reason to stop and reschedule.
- [ ] **Match photo ID to the live person**, with a liveness check.
- [ ] Add an **in-person or notarized step** for remote hires (e.g., the I-9).
- [ ] **Verify references** using contact details you find yourself.
- [ ] **Ship laptops only** to the address on the verified ID.
- [ ] Day one: **alert on KVM / remote-desktop tools** and VPN or VPS logins on new endpoints.
- [ ] **Payee name must match the employee.** Flag repeated bank changes and requests for crypto or money-transfer pay.
- [ ] Watch for **code repositories copied** to personal accounts.
- [ ] Require **subcontractors to verify** their workers' identities, in the contract.

INTERVIEW RED FLAGS

Glancing at another monitor · voices in the background · repeated freezes · refuses in-person meetings · photo ID doesn't match · video that looks manipulated

2 The Call

Finance, executives, ops, help desk

- [ ] **Call back** on a number from your own directory, never one in the message, for every payment, bank-detail change, MFA reset, or OT change.
- [ ] **Two approvers** for transfers and banking changes.
- [ ] A mandatory **cooling-off period** for anything urgent and "confidential."
- [ ] Voice-requested **OT or control-room changes** get out-of-band confirmation first.
- [ ] Help desk: **no password or MFA resets** on a voice alone.
- [ ] Report reaching you via a link? **Type ic3.gov yourself.** Spoofed IC3 sites exist.

Secrecy + urgency = stop. Video calls can be faked end to end. Verify outside the channel the request came through.

3 The Clone

You, your family, your leadership team

- [ ] Agree on a **code phrase** with family and executives, in person. Never post it, text it, or say it on a recorded call.
- [ ] Tell clients and staff **what you will never ask for** by voice or video: payments, credentials, urgent access.
- [ ] Publish a short **"how to verify it's really me"** note.
- [ ] Assume your public talks, podcasts, and videos are **enough to clone you**.
- [ ] Treat audio and video glitches as a **reason to pause**, never as proof either way.

WHY NOT JUST DETECT IT?

Detection helps on some channels, but no tool gives a trustworthy verdict on a live call, and the FBI warns cloned voices can sound nearly identical.

If it happens

Speed of reporting is a control.

1. **Money moved?** Call your bank now and request a recall.
2. **Report** at **ic3.gov**, to the **FBI Tampa Field Office** (Central Florida), and to **CISA** at cisa.gov/report, even if no money was lost.
3. **Paid a suspected DPRK worker?** Talk to counsel first; payments may violate sanctions. Consider OFAC voluntary self-disclosure.

PRESERVE

Résumés, interview recordings, submitted IDs · shipping addresses · payroll account details · IP and RMM logs · call and meeting recordings · wire details

Sources: FBI/State joint alert (Jul 31, 2026); Japan NPA/FBI/DC3/ASD/BND/BfV advisory (Sep 18, 2026); FBI IC3 PSAs I-012325 (Jan 2025) and I-072026 (Jul 2026); OFAC/State/FBI DPRK IT Worker Guidance; Center for Internet Security, *Deepfakes and Synthetic Media: The Emerging Threat to Large-Scale Public Gatherings* (2026). This checklist is general guidance, not legal advice.

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